US MARINE UNIFORM

When the Marines went into Vietnam in 1965, they suffered a shortage of kit suitable for their environment. Jungle fatigues (officially known as Tropical Combat Uniforms) were not issued until 1966–67, replacing previous standard olive green utilities (OG-107s). The hazards of patrols and sweeps in Vietnam, where booby-trap devices inflicted a heavy toll in casualties, meant that protection was a high priority – hence the wearing of flak jackets and the eventual adoption of reinforced footwear.

Manganese steel

M1 helmet
The M1 had a shallower shape than the World War II helmet. It was found that the deeper bowl of the earlier model could not be pressed as hard during manufacture. The pressure clip was introduced to reduce the risk of the owner being choked.

Coat tropical WR Class II
The tight cotton poplin weave on this shirt made it wind resistant and almost waterproof. The fabric was found to be the best mix of breathability and defence against biting insects.

T1 pressure clip

Rope ridge to prevent slippage of weapon sling

Doron (fibreglass and plastic) plates inside vest

M1955 armoured vest
A Marine was expected to wear a nylon-Doron armoured vest when on patrol or in combat. It would not often stop a bullet, but it did defend against shrapnel. It was heavy and hot to wear in tropical conditions, and many men were wounded or killed after removing their jackets for comfort.

M16 magazine

Shoulder pads not issued but procured by Marines for comfort

Pockets used for additional clips

Eyelets used for hanging equipment

Mitchell pattern camouflage



Webbing secured around waist

